

TV Journal

Read Dana's journal to find out what she has learned during TV Turnoff Week. Match each day (0 to 6) with one of her statements (a to i). You may use each statement only once. There are two more statements than you need. There is an example at the beginning (0).

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| 0. Tuesday, 4:30 pm: I go over to the house of my "little sister" Alejandre, whom I mentor. But Alejandre wants to watch her favorite show. I am saved when her mom tells her we won't have time to go to the mall unless her homework is done first. |
| 1. Wednesday, 6:45 pm: I'm at home with my brother Aaron and my mom. Aaron always has the TV on during dinner, and it takes convincing to get him to do otherwise. But I stay strong. |
| 2. Thursday, 10:20 pm: The war in Iraq has started, and I'm in the living room as my mom turns on the news. I remind her I won't watch TV and I leave the room. It feels silly to keep my TV turnoff plan when there is breaking news. But I know that there are other sources for news. |
| 3. Friday, 9:05 am: My first class is biology. The teacher has set up a television, and turns on a program on the Learning Channel. At first I think this is breaking my TV turnoff pledge. I discuss it with a friend, and we agree this does not count. |
| 4. Saturday, 10:00 pm: I'm on a date, and we are not hitting it off. It's still early, but there is no way I'm going to ask him over to my house for fear of the painful conversation and horrible silences without TV. The date ends early. |
| 5. Sunday, 11:46 pm: I try to finish the last pages of <i>A Prayer for Owen Meany</i> . It feels good to finish this 617-page book, especially since I'd written three essays on it a month ago. |
| 6. Monday, 6:35 pm: It is already my last day without TV and I barely notice the time. It wasn't that bad after all! |

source: Isenberg, Dana: Turning off the tube. A report from the trenches. Young People's Press, April 17, 2003.

- a) Information isn't only on TV.
- b) Educational TV is allowed.
- c) No TV means no more junk food.
- d) There's more time to read.
- e) It is possible to live without TV.
- f) Parents can help to keep you away from TV.
- g) Even meals can be TV-free.
- h) Boys can be boring without TV.
- i) There's more time for class papers.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6
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